

MARLI GUIMARÃES FERNANDES

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary fields: Applied microeconomics, Political economy

Research methods: Causal inference, Natural language processing

ACADEMIC POSITION

Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Fellow

09/2025-08/2027

Università Degli Studi di Padova, Department of Economics and Management "Marco Fanno"

Research grant funded by the European Union's Horizon Europe program

Visiting fellow at Harvard Business School (host Prof. Vincent Pons)

Fall 2026

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics

2017 - 2024

Nova School of Business and Economics

Approved with Distinction and Honors

Visiting PhD student at Sciences Po

02/2022 - 04/2022

Master in Economics

2014 - 2016

Major in Public Policy

Nova School of Business and Economics

Undergraduate degree in Economics

2011 - 2014

Nova School of Business and Economics

Exchange Program at Aarhus School of Business and Social Sciences

Fall 2013

AFFILIATIONS

Economics for Policy Knowledge Center (Nova SBE)

2022 - Present

RESEARCH - WORKING PAPERS

When Women Run Against Men: Evidence from Political Platforms

Do female and male candidates campaign differently, and why? Using individual political platforms from French legislative elections between 1981 and 2024, I combine a transformer machine learning model with a regression discontinuity design that exploits the two-round structure of French elections to identify the causal impact of candidate gender on campaign content. Female and male candidates do not emphasize different issues in the first-round; differences emerge only once the campaign narrows to two candidates. Between the two rounds, women's relative emphasis on male-stereotyped topics rises by 5 percentage points, driven by male candidates, who withdraw from these topics and reallocate space to framing the national contest. Women's relative emphasis on female-stereotyped topics falls by 2.2 points, driven by female candidates reducing their emphasis on health. These adjustments are concentrated among candidates who trail after the first-round, yet they bring no detectable electoral return. I provide suggestive evidence that women reduce the prevalence of female-stereotyped topics only when they compete against a woman, and using an LLM-based measure of agentic and communal language, that they adopt a more communal register only when they compete against a man, consistent with the behavior gender stereotypes prescribe.

RESEARCH - WORK IN PROGRESS

Populism Contagion: Strategic Policy Responses to Populist Opponents

(draft available upon request)

Do mainstream politicians adopt the far-right's agenda when they face it at the ballot box? Focusing on French legislative elections (1988-2024), I implement a regression discontinuity design and compare leading mainstream candidates whose far-right opponent barely qualified for the runoff with those whose opponent barely missed the threshold. I first document that facing a far-right opponent raises the mainstream candidate's probability of election by roughly 25 percentage points - evidence of a front républicain in which voters consolidate behind the leading mainstream candidate. Given this selection effect, I bound behavioral responses using the regression discontinuity design with sample selection of Dong (2019). Adjustment occurs in office rather than on the campaign trail: candidates do not change their campaign agendas, but once in parliament, elected candidates who faced the far-right devote 8 to 10 percentage points more of their debate speech to far-right topics in the raw comparison.

How to Win an Election Against a Populist

Stage: data preparation completed. Estimating median voter preferences at the precinct level.

PUBLICATIONS

Ne me quitte pas! School closures and electoral outcomes in France (with José Tavares), *Journal of Economic Geography*, 2026, lbag030.

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Bando Visiting Abroad (DSEA_ALTRO_BIRD26_02) (€ 5500)	2026
dSEA Mini Grant 2026 (€ 2000)	2026
dSEA Mini Grant 2026 (€ 2000)	2026
Marie Skłodowska-Curie postdoctoral fellowship (€ 193,643.28)	2025
Project #POPULISMCONTAGION funded by the European Union's Horizon Europe program	
HORIZON-MSCA-2024-PF-01-01. Grant agreement no. 101205531	
dSEA Mini Grant 2024 (€ 2000)	2024
Fundação para a Ciência e Tecnologia (FCT) Graduate Scholarship	2017-2022
Socrates/Erasmus scholarship (EU)	2013

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

2026 Workshop "The Political Economy of Reforms and the Costs of Populism", COMPTTEXT, Lisbon Micro Group, University of Padova, EPSA, APSA

2025 18th Annual Meeting of the Portuguese Economic Journal

2024 ENS Lyon, Verona Early Career Workshop in Economics, NICEP Conference 2024, 3rd Junior Economists Meeting UniMi - JEM24, BoMoPaV Economics Meeting 2024, "Text-as-Data in Economics" Workshop at the University of Liverpool Management School, 8th Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop, 7th University of Bolzano Workshop on Political Economy, 18th CESifo Workshop on Political Economy

2023 22nd Journées Louis-André Gérard-Varet, 16th Annual Meeting of the Portuguese Economic Journal, European Public Choice Society, Lisbon Micro Group, Nova SBE Applied Micro Lunch

2021 36th Annual Conference of the Italian Association of Labour Economists, 14th Annual Meeting of the Portuguese Economic Journal, 14th Spanish Labour Economics Meeting, SOEP Brown Bag Seminar

POLICY RESEARCH

The effects of non-cognitive skills on the native-migrant labor market gap, *Migration Studies*, Volume 14, Issue 2, 2026.

European Union Continental AI Action Plan: Analysis of the Portuguese Labor Market. 2026

Youth income tax. 2025

European Union Pact on migration and asylum. 2024

Restoring teachers' total service time. 2024

More housing.. 2024

Non-adjustment of the pensions according to law 53-B/2006. 2023

Sustainable employment commitment. 2023

(with Marlon Francisco and Francesco Franco). *Nova SBE Economics for Policy Knowledge Center*

Social mobility in Portugal (with Teresa Bago d'Uva). *Fundação Francisco Manuel dos Santos*. 2017

The empirics of agglomeration economies: the link with productivity. (with Sílvia Santos and Ana Gouveia). *GEE Papers n. 67*. 2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Workshop Natural Language Processing for Social Sciences Summer 2027

Università Degli Studi di Padova

Invited Teaching Assistant - Grader 2018-2020, Spring 2023-2024

Nova School of Business and Economics

Economics of Poverty, Public Finance, Seminar on Current Economic and Financial Issues, Politics for Policy (MSc), Empirical Methods for Finance (MSc); Macroeconomics, Global Business Environment (BSc)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral researcher 02/2024-07/2025

Università Degli Studi di Padova

Research Assistant 2022-2025

Supervisor: Prof. Francesco Franco

Evaluation of public policies in an intergenerational perspective

Research Assistant 2016-2017

Supervisor: Prof. Teresa Bago d'Uva (Erasmus University Rotterdam)

Project "Social Mobility in Portugal".

Economic analyst for Portugal Economy Probe 2015

COMPLEMENTARY EDUCATION

Economic Analysis of Text and other Non-Standard Data ISEG	2026
15th Lisbon Machine Learning Summer School Instituto Superior Técnico	2025
1st Machine Learning Porto Summer School Católica Porto Business School	2021
Big Data (with R) Instituto de Ciências Sociais, Universidade de Lisboa	2019

REFEREE SERVICE

Economic Modelling, Migration Studies, Journal of Institutional Economics

OTHER INFORMATION

Software	Stata, Python, R, Latex, MS Office
Language	Portuguese (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Italian (basic)
Nationality	Portuguese

REFERENCES

Prof. Antonio Nicolò

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Prof. Edoardo Grillo

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Prof. José Tavares (PhD Advisor)

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